

## » FROM THE WORLD OF CRICKET



1

West Indies staged a remarkable comeback in the second Test to secure its first victory on Pakistani soil in 35 years, levelling the series 1-1 with a 120-run win. Chasing 178 with six wickets in hand, Pakistan was undone by West Indies spinners, spearheaded by Jomel Warrican. Warrican finished with match figures of 9 for 70 and a series haul of 19 wickets.



2

West Indies Women emerged victorious in their three-match ODI series against Bangladesh Women, clinching a 2-1 win after dominating the decider. In the deciding match, Karishma Ramharack's outstanding spell of 4 for 12 restricted Bangladesh to just 118, which the West Indies chased down comfortably with eight wickets to spare.



3

Hobart Hurricanes clinched its maiden Big Bash League (BBL) title with a commanding seven-wicket victory over Sydney Thunder in the final. Thunder started strongly with a 97-run opening stand between captain David Warner and Jason Sangha, but Hurricanes' Riley Meredith and Nathan Ellis turned the tide, each claiming three wickets to restrict the target to 183. The Hurricanes raced to victory within 15 overs, thanks to Mitchell Owen's 39-ball 100, which equalled the record held by Craig Simmons for Perth Scorchers against Adelaide Strikers in 2014.



4

Arshdeep Singh was crowned Men's T20I Cricketer of the Year 2024 after an outstanding year in which he claimed 36 wickets in 18 matches at an average of 15.31 and an economy rate of 7.49. With 97 career wickets, the 25-year-old is now India's highest wicket-taker in T20Is. Jasprit Bumrah was named Test Cricketer of the Year, having taken an extraordinary 71 wickets in the calendar year. The 31-year-old averaged just 14.92 per wicket and ended 2024 with a strike rate of 30.1. Smriti Mandhana was awarded Women's ODI Cricketer of the Year after amassing 747 runs in 13 innings at an average of 57.86 and a strike rate of 95.15. Her four ODI centuries in 2024 set a new benchmark in women's cricket.



5

Australia dominated the Women's Ashes series against England, securing a commanding 12-0 lead and setting the stage for a potential whitewash ahead of the one-off Test. In the three ODIs, all-rounder Ashleigh Gardner shone brightly, delivering a three-wicket haul and scoring an unbeaten 42 in the opening game, followed by a century in the final match to guide the visitor to a clean sweep. Defending a modest total of 181 in the second ODI — the lowest-ever successfully defended score in an Ashes ODI — Alana King excelled with figures of 4 for 25, supported by Kim Garth (3/37) and Gardner (1/23), sealing a 21-run victory. Opener Beth Mooney contributed two half-centuries, while Georgia Wareham claimed two three-wicket hauls during the three-match T20I series.